# VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN & GIRLS (VAWG)

Updated descriptive analysis using the newly supplied dataset • 5 November 2026

## Executive summary

The new CSV contains **63,000 rows** and retains the same underlying 12,600 distinct rows as the earlier dataset, with each distinct row repeated five times. After removing exact duplicate rows and excluding missing/non-numeric agreement values, **11,187 distinct valid records** remain for analysis. The dataset covers **70 countries**, six survey statements and survey years 2000–2018. The unweighted mean agreement is **19.8%** and the median is **14.9%**.

| 63,000 | 12,600 | 11,187 | 70 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rows in new CSV | Distinct rows | Distinct valid records | Countries represented |

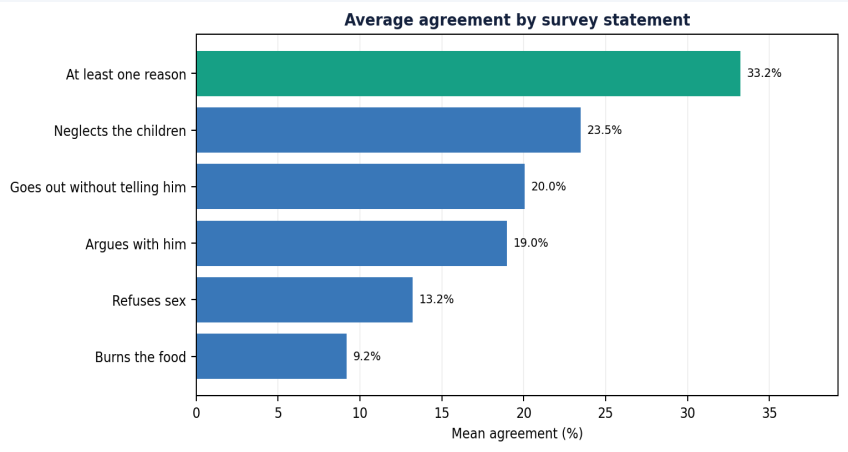
| 19.8% | 14.9% | 0.0–86.9% | 2000–2018 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mean agreement | Median agreement | Observed value range | Survey years |

**Important data-quality finding.** The new file is five times larger in row count, but it does not contain five times as many distinct observations. Exact-row deduplication is required before reporting record totals. Because every row is repeated uniformly five times, the descriptive means and medians remain unchanged; raw row counts would otherwise overstate the amount of data.

**Interpretation.** The Value field represents the percentage of people in a relevant survey group who agree with a statement sometimes used to justify wife-beating. It is an attitude measure, not a measure of actual violence incidence or prevalence. All averages in this report are unweighted because respondent weights/counts are not included.

# 1. Survey statements

The highest mean agreement is for **“At least one reason” (33.2%)**. It is followed by “Neglects the children” (23.5%) and “Goes out without telling him” (20.0%). “Burns the food” has the lowest mean (9.2%). The pattern indicates that agreement differs across the six statements; it does not measure how often violence occurs.



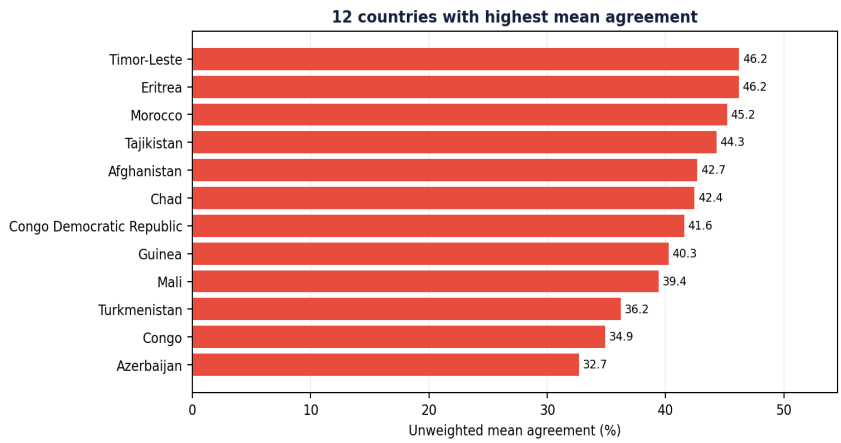

## Statement-level descriptive statistics

| Survey statement | Mean agreement | Median |
|---|---|---|
| At least one reason | 33.2% | 31.0% |
| Neglects the children | 23.5% | 20.8% |
| Goes out without telling him | 20.0% | 16.4% |
| Argues with him | 19.0% | 15.7% |
| Refuses sex | 13.2% | 9.0% |
| Burns the food | 9.2% | 6.4% |

Reading note: the mean is the unweighted average of the available percentage values for each statement.

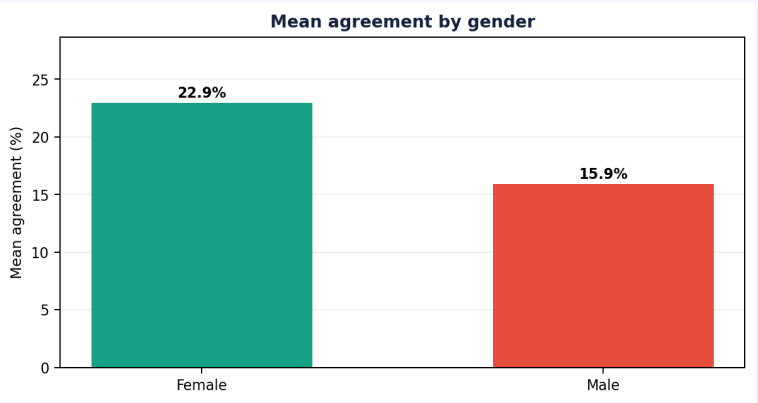
# 2. Country and gender comparisons

The highest country-level means are observed for **Timor-Leste (46.2%)** and **Eritrea (46.2%)**, followed by Morocco (45.2%). These are descriptive averages from the available records. The supplied fields do not include respondent weights or denominators, so the ranking should not be treated as a comparison of population prevalence.




## Gender comparison

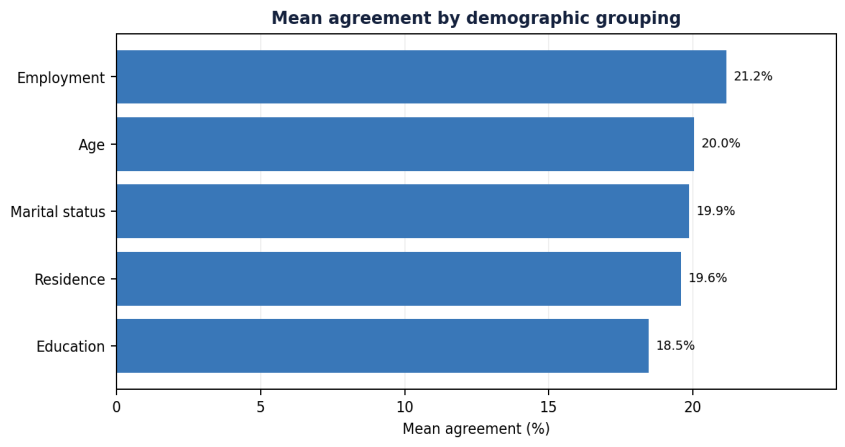
The unweighted mean is **22.9% for female respondents** and **15.9% for male respondents**. The difference is 7.0 percentage points in these available records. This descriptive difference does not establish its cause and should not be interpreted as a causal or population-adjusted result.




Country and gender averages are unweighted; group composition and survey coverage may differ.

# 3. Demographic groupings

Across the five demographic grouping fields, the highest overall mean is for **Employment (21.2%)**, followed by Age (20.0%). The lowest is for Education (18.5%). These averages combine the available response categories within each grouping and are not adjusted for differences in country, year or respondent composition.

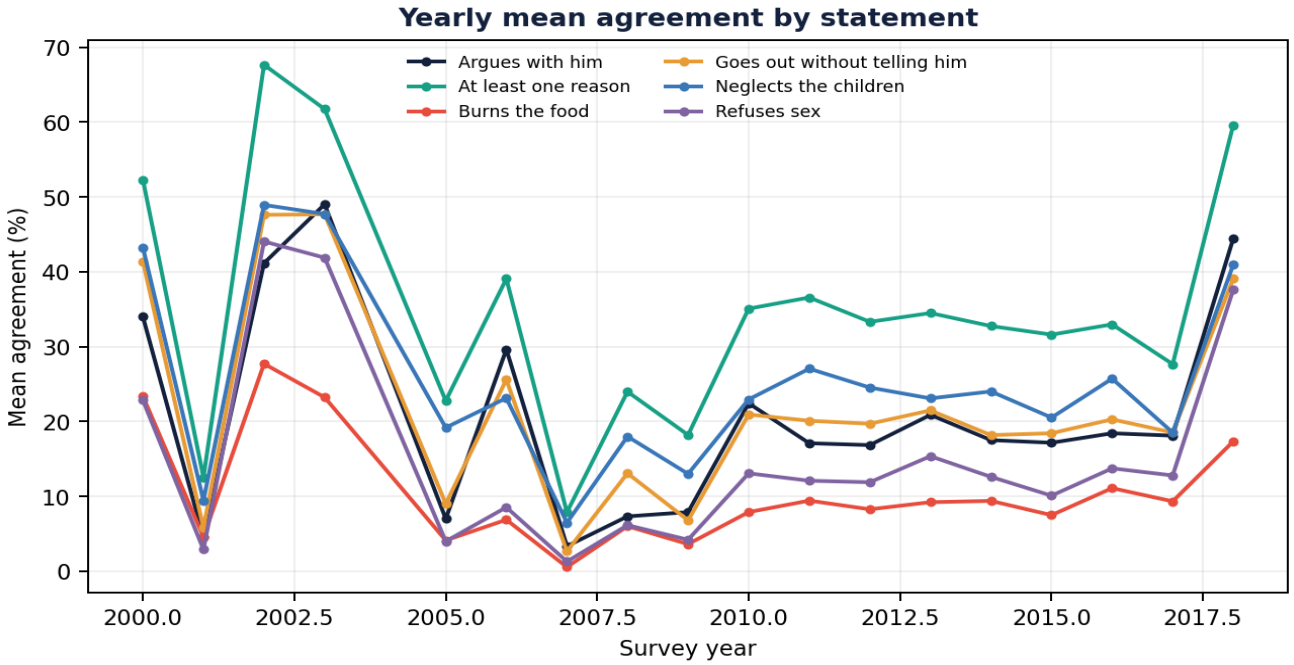



## Examples of higher response-category averages

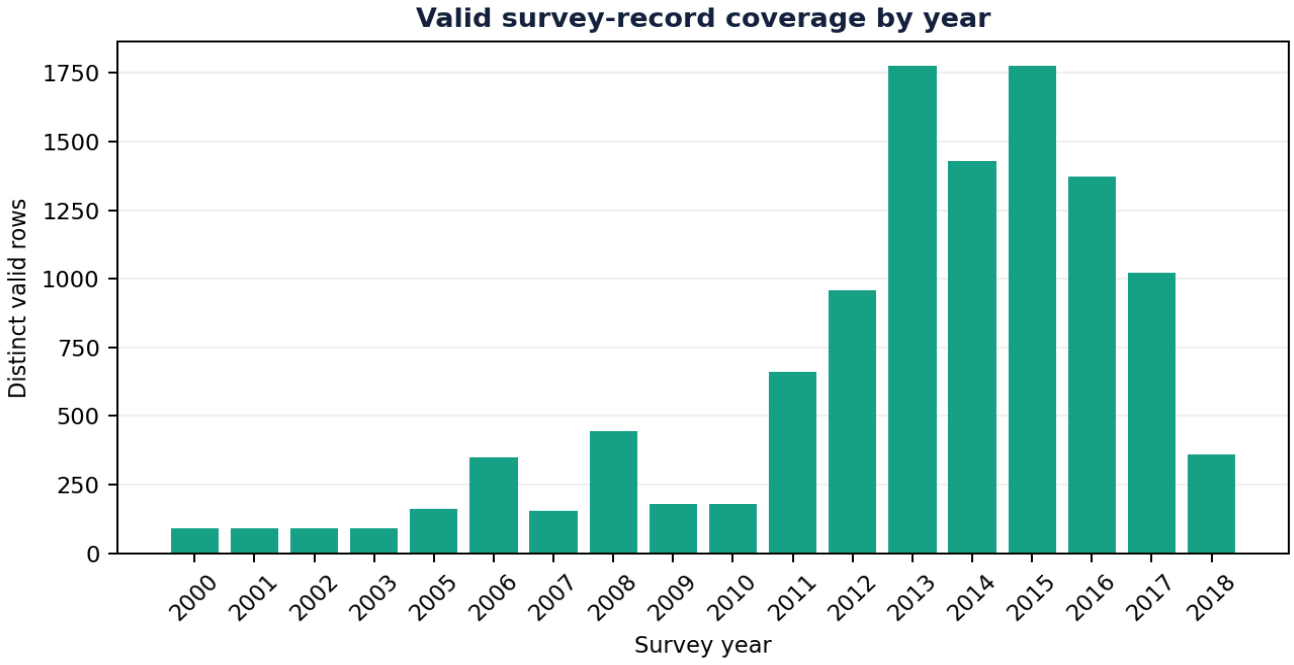
| Demographic grouping | Response category | Mean agreement | Valid rows |
|---|---|---|---|
| Education | No education | 25.4% | 704 |
| Employment | Employed for kind | 24.4% | 740 |
| Residence | Rural | 23.3% | 758 |
| Education | Primary | 22.8% | 728 |
| Age | 15-24 | 21.1% | 758 |
| Marital status | Widowed, divorced, separated | 20.7% | 752 |
| Marital status | Married or living together | 20.2% | 758 |
| Age | 25-34 | 19.7% | 758 |

The response-category table lists the eight highest means among the available combinations. Small group sizes and differences in survey coverage may affect these comparisons.

# 4. Survey-year patterns and coverage

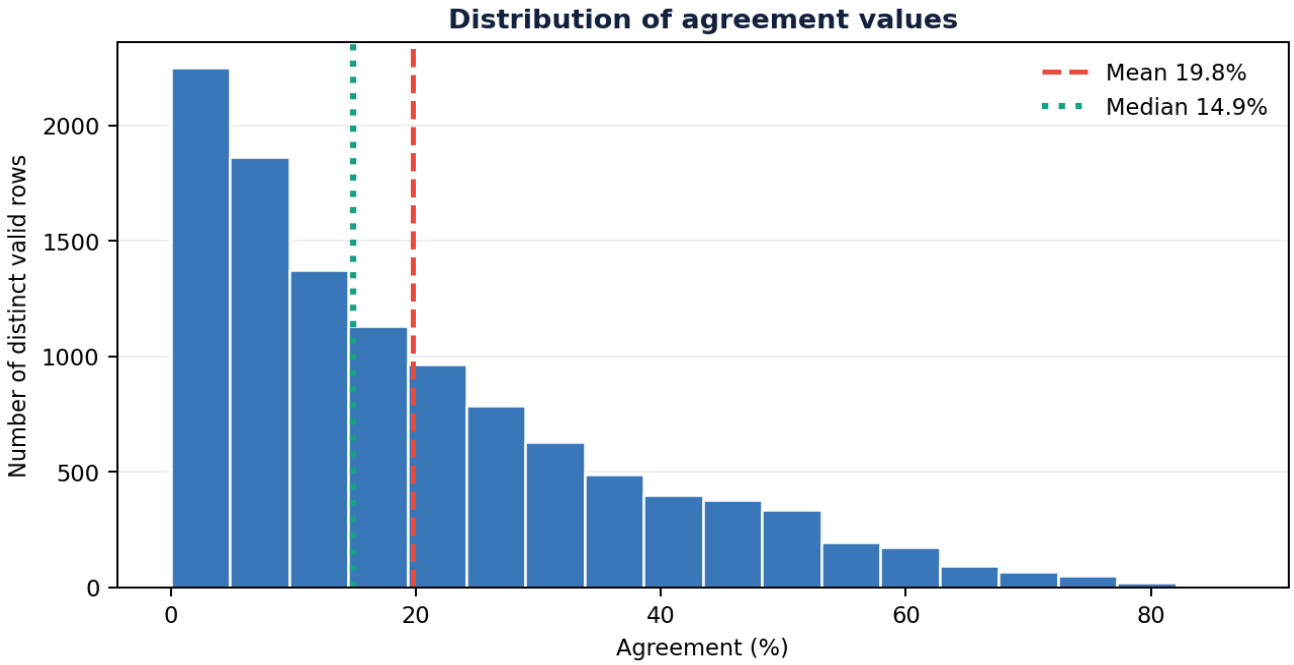



The annual lines show the mean agreement percentage for each statement in years where records are available. The values vary across years, but the dataset combines different countries and demographic groups over time. Changes in the composition and availability of records may therefore contribute to apparent year-to-year differences.




Coverage is uneven across the 2000–2018 period. The highest distinct valid record counts occur in 2013, 2015, 2014. Yearly averages should not be interpreted as a controlled longitudinal trend or as proof of population-wide change.

# 5. Distribution of agreement values

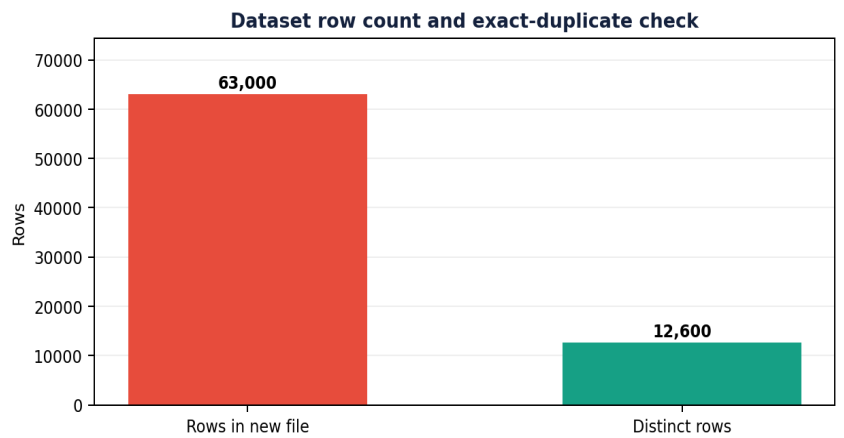



The overall mean is 19.8% and the median is 14.9%. The mean is higher than the median, indicating that the distribution has a higher-value tail. Values range from 0.0% to 86.9%, with a standard deviation of 17.0 percentage points. The histogram describes the distribution of survey agreement values, not the distribution of violence incidents.

The median is less affected by a small number of high values than the mean. Reporting both provides a more complete summary of the centre of this distribution.

# 6. Data quality and processing notes

The new file has **63,000 rows**, but only **12,600 distinct full rows**. This means 50,400 rows are exact duplicates and each distinct row appears 5 times. The valid analysis set contains 55,935 rows before deduplication and 11,187 distinct valid rows after deduplication. There are 7,065 rows with missing Value entries in the supplied file.




## Recommended handling

1. Deduplicate exact repeated rows before publishing counts or record totals.
2. Keep the original source file unchanged and document the deduplication step in the analysis pipeline.
3. Continue excluding missing/non-numeric Value entries from percentage calculations.
4. Do not interpret repeated copies as additional respondents or independent observations.
5. For formal country or demographic comparisons, use survey weights and respondent denominators if they become available.

The uniform fivefold replication does not change the calculated mean or median when all copies are identical. It does inflate row counts, counts by year, and any totals based on the raw file. Therefore, the report uses distinct rows for analytical record counts.

# 7. Dashboard capabilities and conclusion

## Dashboard functionality in the supplied Python application

The supplied Dash application provides filters for country, gender, demographic grouping, demographic response, survey statement and survey year. Its overview displays average agreement, countries represented, survey records and the highest reported value. The graph explorer includes pie, vertical bar, horizontal bar, scatter, line, heatmap, histogram, boxplot and area visualizations. A filtered data table supports sorting and filtering, and the application can export the selected records as CSV.

## Conclusion

The updated dataset preserves the earlier descriptive findings: “At least one reason” has the highest statement mean (33.2%), “Burns the food” the lowest (9.2%), and the overall mean and median remain 19.8% and 14.9%. Female respondents have a higher unweighted mean than male respondents in the available records, and country averages vary substantially. The newly identified issue is the fivefold exact duplication of rows in the new CSV. This must be accounted for whenever reporting sample or record counts.

These findings can support further investigation, awareness planning and identification of topics for deeper analysis. They should be combined with appropriately weighted survey estimates, contextual research and direct evidence on violence and services before informing operational targets or evaluating interventions.

## Key limitations

The Value field measures attitudes/perceived justifications, not actual violence incidence or prevalence. Respondent counts and survey weights are not present in the supplied fields, so all averages are unweighted. Survey coverage and group composition vary across countries and years. Exact duplicate rows in the new file inflate raw row counts and must be removed for accurate record totals.

Source files: violence_data(3).csv; app(20261105-121410).py; previous VAWG dashboard visual report. Analysis date: 5 November 2026.